

Standard Chartered (STAN.L/2888.HK): 30th European Financials Conference — Key Takeaways

European Financials Conference
2-4 June 2026 | Zurich
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Presenters: Manus Costello, Interim Group Chief Financial Officer, presented at our 30th Goldman Sachs European Financials Conference 2026.

Bottom Line: Management discussed: 1) current operating dynamics during Q2 so far; 2) asset quality trends; 3) capital efficiency improvements through structural levers; and 4) recent CSRC actions relating to cross-border funds.

Key Takeaways

Continued momentum into Q2: Within markets, management highlighted solid flow momentum so far within Q2 following strong performance in Q1, albeit while flagging a relatively tough comparison on episodic income given outsized 1H25 levels; in banking, management remains pleased with origination levels supporting ongoing momentum following the Q1 print; and in wealth, management confirmed that the beneficial conditions which enabled heightened Q1 wealth activity have remained in place during Q2 (albeit while reiterating that Q1 NNM is not necessarily reflective of the annualised run-rate).

Asset quality: LLR guidance reiterated at 30-35bp, following the Q1 print of 32bp (including a macro overlay), with management embedding a degree of conservatism in part given the bank's extensive footprint across 54 countries, cognisant of potential credit and counterparty risks within the current environment. Overall, management remains comfortable with asset quality across the book, emphasising the gradual and ongoing shift towards becoming a lower risk institution, in part supported by business mix shifts; such as within WRB given the focus on the affluent segment alongside the exit of certain unsecured balances; as well within the CIB given the focus on larger corporates.

Capital efficiency improvements: Management emphasised how the recently outlined strategic plan includes a multi-year uplift in RWA productivity (with RWA growth set to trend below the 5-7% income CAGR target range across 2025-28), supported in part by the aforementioned business mix shifts (including the focus on

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Financial Institutions and Networks in the CIB, given that larger cross-border corporates are typically more RWA-productive). As the majority of sub-optimal RWA avenues have already been exited, management noted that the focus going forward will be on improving returns in select areas that remain less productive. Management still remains committed to deploying RWA (reiterating the recently outlined capital framework, towards a roughly equal 1/3 split between RWA growth, dividends, and available remaining capital which is most likely to be deployed via SBBs (i.e. a shift from STAN's prior allocation in recent years of c.25%/75% RWA growth vs distribution).

CSRC actions: Management noted that, following recent CSRC (Chinese Securities Regulatory Commission) actions regarding cross-border funds for mainland China customers — STAN's existing policies are largely in line with the proposed actions, while the majority of actions are more applicable to the brokerage space rather than to banks. Management stressed the importance of its existing internal processes in terms of new account openings, transaction monitoring, while noting that banks will look to address additional steps (such as closing zero-balance accounts that have existed for an extended period of time).

Valuation/Risks

We value STAN using a target multiple of 10.25x applied 75%/25% to 2027/28E estimates to arrive at 12-month target prices of 2,260p/HK\$242. We are Buy rated. Downside risks to our view and price target include reversal/pause of positive jaws delivery, slower-than-expected non-interest income growth, lower-than-expected net interest income growth.

Investment Thesis

Standard Chartered is a global bank with over 650 branches in 53 markets. STAN HK is the third-largest player, holding ~12%/11% of HK local market shares in deposits/loans. We are Buy rated on STAN.L/2888.HK given (1) Robust and sustained momentum in the affluent segment. We see the bank as well-positioned to leverage the robust and sustained liquidity inflows into Hong Kong and Singapore, a significant tailwind that we believe will continue to fuel its growth and differentiate its performance from peers. (2) Positive trajectory in Global Markets and Banking, underpinned by steady market share gains. (3) Positive jaws with scope to further unlock operational leverage. (4) Attractive shareholder returns with total yield (dividend + buybacks) ranking among the top quartile of DM comps. We expect statutory ROTC to trend above 12% for 2026E (target >12%), and to improve notably further in 2027-28E.

Disclosure Appendix

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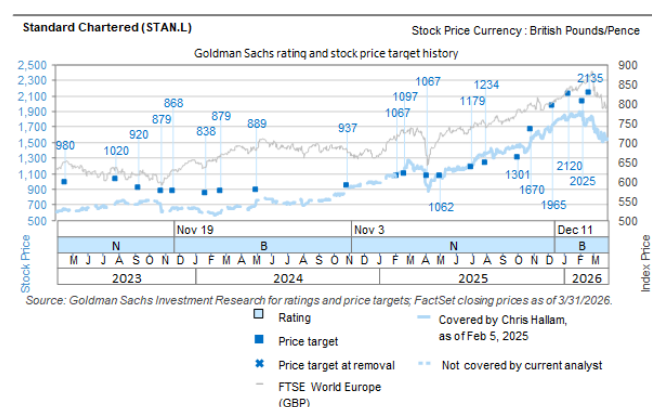
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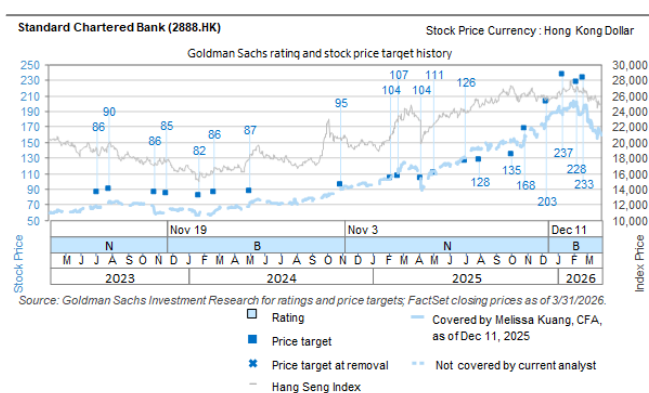
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Target price history table(s)

Standard Chartered Bank (2888.HK)

Date of report	Target price (HK\$)	Closing price (HK\$)
22-May-26	242.00	204.00
30-Apr-26	243.00	190.80
21-Apr-26	237.00	192.40
24-Feb-26	233.00	197.90
09-Feb-26	228.00	202.00
13-Jan-26	237.00	191.60
11-Dec-25	203.00	177.00
30-Oct-25	168.00	159.50
03-Oct-25	135.00	152.60
31-Jul-25	128.00	142.00
04-Jul-25	126.00	130.30
02-May-25	111.00	113.60
07-Apr-25	104.00	91.50
21-Feb-25	107.00	116.00
05-Feb-25	104.00	103.60
30-Oct-24	95.00	90.75
02-May-24	87.00	71.95
23-Feb-24	86.00	62.45
23-Jan-24	82.00	58.00
19-Nov-23	85.00	61.30
26-Oct-23	86.00	59.75
28-Jul-23	90.00	74.50
06-Jul-23	86.00	66.55

Standard Chartered (STAN.L)

Date of report	Target price (£)	Closing price (£)
30-Apr-26	2,260	1,862.8
21-Apr-26	2,165	1,806
24-Feb-26	2,135	1,789
09-Feb-26	2,025	1,899
13-Jan-26	2,120	1,832
11-Dec-25	1,965	1,717
30-Oct-25	1,670	1,571
03-Oct-25	1,301	1,467
31-Jul-25	1,234	1,360.5
04-Jul-25	1,179	1,207
02-May-25	1,062	1,096.5
07-Apr-25	1,067	937.2
21-Feb-25	1,097	1,183
05-Feb-25	1,067	1,074
30-Oct-24	937	912.6
02-May-24	889	756
23-Feb-24	879	635
23-Jan-24	838	605.8
19-Nov-23	868	660
26-Oct-23	879	625.2
12-Sep-23	920	725.4
28-Jul-23	1,020	737.6

Price targets shown in table(s) are unadjusted for corporate actions.

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